

Moving around directories

The primary thing one has to learn in the loop of learning Linux is the art of navigating the files system of this operating system. Under this topic, the following commands will be introduced:

- `pwd`: Print Working Directory
- `cd`: Change Directory
- `ls`: List Directory

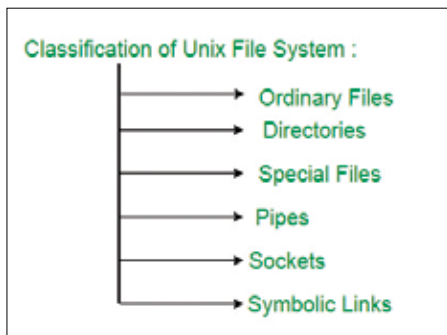
Understanding the Linux file system

Like any operating system, Linux also organises its files in a hierarchical directory system, which means they are arranged in a tree-like system of directors, also called folders. The first directory in Linux is the root directory, which contains other directories and file systems which further contain subdirectories and subfiles. Unlike Windows that has system trees for each storage device that is attached, a Linux system has a single system tree regardless of the number of storage devices attached to the computer. It always depends on the system administrator in how they choose to manipulate these file systems.

Current working directory

All of us are familiar with the graphical interface of directories. One peculiar thing about these file managers is that these are upended trees. This means that the root of these trees are attached to the top while they are free from the bottom. One can always see the parent directory from which the particular directory you are working on is attached to. Coming back to the Command line, there is no graphical representation or interface structure that can accurately tell you which directory you are working in so to display the current directory we are working in; we can use the `pwd` or Print Working Directory command.

Note: When we first login to the terminal, we are logged into the home directory. Every user is given its home directory, and this is the only place a regular user is allowed to write commands and files.



A Brief overview of the Linux File System Tree

Source: <https://media.geeksforgeeks.org/wp-content/cdn-uploads/unix-file-system.png>